

WEEKLY BUSINESS SESSION –July 29, 2026

9:00m. – Anne Basker Auditorium
600 N.W. Sixth Street, Grants Pass, OR 97526

Present: Ron Smith, Chair-Commissioner; Colene Martin, Vice-Chair-Commissioner and Gary Richardson, Commissioner, Nikole Guzman, Recorder

These are meeting minutes only. Only text enclosed in quotation marks reports a speaker's exact words.

Pursuant to notice through the media and in conformance with the Public Meeting Law, Ron Smith, Chair, called the meeting to order at 9:00 a.m. followed by the Pledge of Allegiance.

Items discussed were as follows:

1. **CALL MEETING TO ORDER:** Pursuant to notice through the media and in conformance with the Public Meeting Law, Ron Smith, Chair, called the meeting to order at 9:00 a.m.
2. **DECLARE A POTENTIAL CONFLICT OF INTEREST:** The commissioners reserved their right to declare a potential conflict of interest. None
3. **REQUESTS/COMMENTS FROM CITIZENS:** *(Each person will be given three (3) minutes to speak)*
Judy Aherns, Josephine County, spoke about a televised congressional hearing concerning Dr. Anthony Fauci and the federal response to the COVID-19 pandemic.

BOARD MAY REVIEW PUBLIC COMMENTS/QUESTIONS:

4. **APPROVAL OF CONSENT CALENDAR:**

- a. **Minutes** *(Draft minutes are available for viewing in the Board's Office)*

Admin Workshop – July 21, 2026

Weekly Business Session – July 22, 2026

Commissioner Martin made a motion to approve the Consent Calendar, seconded by Commissioner Richardson. Upon roll call, Commissioner Richardson –yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.

5. **OTHER: (ORS 192.640(1))** “. . . notice shall include a list of the principal subjects anticipated to be considered at the meeting, but this requirement shall not limit the ability of a governing body to consider additional subjects.”)
Commissioner Smith again reminded the public that Josephine County remained in fire season. He commended the Oregon Department of Forestry and other responding firefighters for their work on the East Evans Creek Fire, noting that the incident could have become substantially more severe.

6. **ANNOUNCEMENTS: MATTERS FROM COMMISSIONERS:**

Commissioner Richardson shared information from a recent visit to Wallace, Idaho. He discussed the historic Great Fire of 1910, which burned approximately three million acres across three states within 72 hours. He used the historical event to emphasize that extremely destructive wildfires have long occurred and urged the public to remain careful with fire.

Commissioner Martin announced that the Josephine County Fair began that evening. She highlighted the opening-night Rough Stock Rodeo, the Clay Walker concert scheduled for the following evening, and the weekend monster-truck events. She noted that general admission to the Fair was free, while evening events required separate tickets, with additional information available online.

Commissioner Martin encouraged residents to attend and enjoy the Fair as a community event. She commended Recreation Director Tamra Martin and Fairgrounds staff for their work and stated that the Fair continued to improve each year.

Weekly Business Session adjourned at 9:08 a.m.



Nikole Guzman, Recorder